



Opt for a 4K TV if you plan to stick to it for 5-8 years

quality. For HD (720p) content and beyond, a minimum viewing distance of 5 feet between the screen and the viewer is fine for a 50-inch TV. Visit this link (<http://dgit.in/Nv15bz>) for THX's guide to calculating viewing distance precisely. The real issue comes in when you switch to SD (standard definition) content. SD content on a 50-inch panel will appear pixelated. The non-wide (4:3) aspect ratio of most SD content channels will make things even worse. So, if your primary usage for a TV is limited to SD content, going beyond a 42-inch screen size will compromise picture quality and experience. Bottom-line: sacrifice on some features if you must so you can buy a larger screen size that supports at least 1080p native resolution.

A SMART TV MIGHT NOT ALWAYS BE THE SMARTEST OPTION

Spending more on a Smart TV might not be the best option today. Sure a Smart TV will offer wireless connectivity, giving you access to more content over the web. But, why spend more when you can convert your standard TV into a Smart TV? You can connect a Chromecast dongle, an Apple TV or a Google Android TV based device to your TV using the HDMI port and convert your TV into a Smart TV. The UI, content options and overall experience offered by these devices easily matches and even surpasses the best of Smart TVs in the market today. The Google Nexus player based on Android TV or an Apple TV can be purchased for less than ₹6000 via online

stores. Chromecast will cost you less than ₹3000 and will offer benefits of seamlessly beaming content from your smartphone, laptop or a desktop PC to your TV. Smart TVs do command a premium and in most cases the premium is upwards of ₹10,000. Spending the extra cash on getting a bigger screen and investing on separate devices is an option that you should explore. The only real downside to this approach is that you will end up using-up an HDMI port to connect the device, whereas the features are in-built in a smart TV. A compromise you should be aware of, if you are planning to connect multiple devices to the TV.

SHOULD YOU GO 4K?

Yes, 4K is now affordable. While content is still an issue, you could still consider

opting for a 4K TV, assuming you would stick to it for 5-8 years. However, please be wary of those ultra low-cost 4K TVs that tease you with their unbelievable price tags. A lot has been said on how one cannot make out the difference in image quality between a 4K TV and a 1080p TV at standard viewing distances (5-9 feet). We humbly disagree with those opinions. You will most certainly realise the difference in terms of image quality between a 4K TV and a 1080p TV, provided both are playing the same content in the native resolution of the TV. Though, the maximum impact of 4K or UHD resolution is felt on larger screen sizes (55-inch and above). For anyone considering a 42-inch panel, we recommend buying a good quality 1080p LED TV with local dimming and save that cash to upgrade to a 4K TV in the next 3-5 years. Especially, if you're going 4K is up for consideration, but does not figure in the 'must-have' features list.

INEXPENSIVE 4K TVs CAN BE EVIL

Low-cost 4K TVs often come with crappy panels that only support 4K at 30 Hz, that is basically limiting the video playback to a 30 Hz refresh rate per second. And, these TVs suffer from awful judder when playing fast action content (sports channels or anything that contains rapid panning). What's worse, many of them come with default up-scaling, so when they are set to 4K, they upscale SD and HD content to 4K and hence force the 30hz refresh rate on regular content as well. Thereby adding the same awful judder to every-



VU TVs give a lot of bang for your buck